rate NDK (Native Development Kit) which allows you to write native code for the target platform (remember that Android can be made to run on an Intel machine as well, while most mobile phones run on the ARM platform). The NDK compiles code to binary for the native platform. If you are going to program games which need OpenGL, you would need NDK in most cases to leverage the hardware capabilities.

What frameworks do I have to aid me?

It goes without saying that frameworks are built around a particular language (the only exception to this would *be .NET* framework which supports multiple languages). You can neither use CodeIgniter for creating a Java based app nor Qt framework for writing a Python script. We have already mentioned that the choice of language, IDE, development platform etc depend on the target platform. This translates to frameworks being mutually exclusive for mobile platforms. In addition to this, frameworks which need to run on the mobile platform have to use the platform specific APIs. This shrinks the possibility to have cross-platform frameworks for AR uses. Here we list out the most popular and useful frameworks available to ease up the process of building AR apps.

OpenCV

A list of libraries which could help you do AR would be incomplete without OpenCV. OpenCV stands for Open Source Computer Vision and is one of the most famous libraries in the computer vision field. In case you are unaware, computer vision is the field of study which deals with any and every topic methods of acquiring, extracting, analyzing and understanding information from images to help a computer for take decisions in real world. Object recognition technologies come under the umbrella of computer vision. OpenCV claims to have more than 2500 optimised algorithms for computer vision of which, a majority can be useful in creating recognition based AR apps.

OpenCV can be a great aid to AR programmers because of the language bindings that it offers. OpenCV has interfaces in C, C++ and Python as of now and soon, it would be available for Java as well. Since iOS apps need to be written in objective C, one can utilise OpenCV's faculties by importing the library into the application. The fact that Windows phones can be programmed in multiple languages is a benefit and OpenCV can be used with C++ for Windows phones. As far as Android is concerned, you can use the